THE HOUSE OF IDEAS

CHAPTER NINETEEN

“BORN HYDRA”

February 7, 2013 – April 14, 2014
Burbank • Hollywood • Culver City • Albany, Georgia

An Alternate-History Hollywood Saga

PROLOGUE: PAGE NINETY-ONE

INT. DONOHUE ENTERTAINMENT - EXECUTIVE TOWER - BOARDROOM - BURBANK - DAY

SUPER: THURSDAY, FEBRUARY 7, 2013 - 10:00 A.M. PST - FIFTY-THREE DAYS BEFORE "THE WINTER SOLDIER" STARTS FILMING

A long glass table on the top floor. Burbank spread out below in winter sunshine. At the head of the table: NATASHA BULLOCK (51). On her left: KEVIN FEIGE (39) and the directors ANTHONY RUSSO (43) and JOE RUSSO (41). On her right: JEPH LOEB (55), head of Marvel Television, with a thick binder labeled "AGENTS OF S.H.I.E.L.D. - SEASON ONE - ABC."

In front of each person, a single page, numbered 91. Each is watermarked with that person's name in gray diagonal letters.

NATASHA
I have read page ninety-one four times. I'd like someone to read it out loud. So we all understand what we're about to do to my television network.

Joe Russo looks at his brother. Anthony nods. Joe picks up the page.

JOE RUSSO
(reading)
"INT. CAMP LEHIGH - UNDERGROUND VAULT. The wall of 1970s computer banks flickers to life. On the screen, a face made of green light: ARNIM ZOLA. ZOLA: You believe HYDRA crept into S.H.I.E.L.D. like a worm into an apple, Captain. No. We planted the tree. In 1946, when they built S.H.I.E.L.D., they built it with our hands. Every agent you trusted. Every order you obeyed. S.H.I.E.L.D. was never infiltrated. S.H.I.E.L.D. was born HYDRA."

He puts the page down. Silence around the table.

ANTHONY RUSSO
It's from Jonathan Hickman's SECRET WARRIORS. 2009. Nick Fury finds out the agency he built his life around was a HYDRA operation from the very first day. It's one of the best twists Marvel has ever published.

JEPH LOEB
And I have an ABC show called AGENTS OF S.H.I.E.L.D. premiering in September, Kevin. The title has the word S.H.I.E.L.D. in it. In big letters.

FEIGE
I know, Jeph.

JEPH LOEB
Our movie comes out in April. Halfway through our first season. On a Friday. And the following Tuesday, my lead character works for an organization that doesn't exist anymore.

NATASHA
Is that true? At the end of this film, S.H.I.E.L.D. doesn't exist?

JOE RUSSO
Steve Rogers tears it down. In front of the whole world. He dumps every secret file on the internet, HYDRA and S.H.I.E.L.D. alike. Congress dissolves it. Fury goes underground.

ANTHONY RUSSO
There's no S.H.I.E.L.D. after this. There's no safety net for the Avengers. No helicarrier. No Fury on the phone. They're on their own.

Natasha takes her glasses off and sets them on page ninety-one.

NATASHA
Kevin. Seven years ago, you told a room of six thousand people that nobody gets nerfed. I didn't own you then. I own you now. And I am asking you, as the person who signs the checks for ABC, the parks, the toys and the lunchboxes: does it have to be this?

Feige is quiet for a long moment.

FEIGE
Natasha. When Nick Fury finds out in SECRET WARRIORS, he says the line that the whole run is built around. He says, "Everything I built was a lie, so I'll build something true."

(beat)
If we give the audience a S.H.I.E.L.D. that just had a few bad apples, we're nerfing the story. We're nerfing Steve. A man who woke up from the ice to find out his country turned into something he doesn't recognize has to look at the most powerful institution on earth and say no. That's the movie. That's Captain America.

Jeph Loeb looks down at his binder. Then he laughs, quietly, almost to himself.

JEPH LOEB
You know what? It's the best thing that could happen to my show.

NATASHA
Explain.

JEPH LOEB
Nineteen episodes of "everything's fine at S.H.I.E.L.D." Then a Tuesday in April when everything's on fire, and Coulson finds out the people he's been working with are HYDRA. Our whole back half becomes about it. No network show has ever had a movie blow up its world in the middle of a season. People will tune in just to see what's left.

Natasha considers this. She looks at the Russos.

NATASHA
Who knows about this page?

ANTHONY RUSSO
The people in this room. Our writers, Markus and McFeely. Tyrese. Tyler. Harmony. Toby Jones, because he has to say it.

NATASHA
And my son?

FEIGE
(carefully)
Your son is in the end-credits scene. He'll get his page the night before.

NATASHA
And Amond Baker?

A beat. Everyone at the table, even Natasha, almost smiles.

FEIGE
Amond Baker will find out with the rest of America.

NATASHA
(putting her glasses back on)
Then I approve. Shred the pages on your way out. All of them.

CUT TO:

THE HOLLYWOOD REPORTER - TUESDAY, MARCH 11, 2014 - REVIEW

'CAPTAIN AMERICA: THE WINTER SOLDIER': A PARANOID 1970s THRILLER IN A SUPERHERO SUIT, AND A GAME-CHANGER

"Don't read anything else before you see it. There's a turn two-thirds of the way through that doesn't just change this movie, it rewires every Marvel film that came before it. Tyrese Avery, once dismissed as 'a pop star who acts,' delivers the most quietly devastating performance in the franchise. Tyler Chapman's Winter Soldier is the scariest thing Marvel has put on screen."

VARIETY - REVIEW - TUESDAY, MARCH 11, 2014

'THE WINTER SOLDIER': MARVEL'S BEST, AND ITS MOST DANGEROUS

"In a year when Americans are arguing about the NSA, drones and who watches the watchers, Marvel has made a $170 million blockbuster in which Captain America decides the government agency he works for cannot be saved. The Russo brothers shot the film's car chases on real Washington streets and its elevator fight in a real office tower, and they shot Avery's fights with no cutaways. You can see that it's him."

ROTTENTOMATOES.COM - CAPTAIN AMERICA: THE WINTER SOLDIER (2014)

TOMATOMETER: 92% (164 reviews) - Critics Consensus: *"Suspenseful and politically astute, THE WINTER SOLDIER is a superior entry in the Marvel canon, with a twist that changes everything."*

PART ONE: THE PREMIERE

EXT. EL CAPITAN THEATRE - HOLLYWOOD BOULEVARD - EVENING

SUPER: THURSDAY, MARCH 13, 2014 - 5:45 P.M. PDT - WORLD PREMIERE OF "CAPTAIN AMERICA: THE WINTER SOLDIER"

Hollywood Boulevard in red, white and blue. The El Capitan's marquee: "CAPTAIN AMERICA: THE WINTER SOLDIER - WORLD PREMIERE." Above the doors, a forty-foot S.H.I.E.L.D. eagle banner. Fans in Captain America gear by the hundred, and a growing number in black tactical masks and a silver metal arm made of painted cardboard and aluminum foil.

A wounded-veterans organization has an entire bleacher on the carpet: men and women in uniform, some in wheelchairs, some with prosthetic arms of their own, a few holding up their prosthetics as if in salute to the Winter Soldier banner.

EXT. EL CAPITAN THEATRE - RED CARPET - CONTINUOUS

SUPER: 5:58 P.M. PDT

TYRESE AVERY (32) steps out of a black SUV in a navy tuxedo with a tiny silver star on the lapel. The screams are deafening. He doesn't go to the press line. He goes straight to the veterans' bleacher and starts shaking hands, one by one, all the way down the row.

An ENTERTAINMENT TONIGHT CORRESPONDENT gets him eventually.

ET CORRESPONDENT
Tyrese! The critics are saying this is the best Marvel movie ever made. And there's a twist that "changes everything." Can you give us a hint?

TYRESE
(smiling, but serious)
My grandfather fought at the Battle of the Bulge. He came home in uniform and couldn't sit at the lunch counter in his own town. He loved this country anyway. He used to say Captain America is what America's supposed to be.

(beat)
In this movie, Steve finds out what "supposed to be" costs. That's my hint.

CUT TO:

EXT. EL CAPITAN THEATRE - RED CARPET - LATER

SUPER: 6:10 P.M. PDT

TYLER CHAPMAN (32) walks the carpet with his long Winter Soldier hair tied back, in a black suit with one silver cufflink. A disabled Army veteran at the barricade, SERGEANT DENISE OKAFOR (34), holds out her carbon-fiber prosthetic arm. Tyler stops and bumps his fist against it.

SGT. OKAFOR
I lost mine in Kandahar. My kids call me the Winter Soldier now.

TYLER
(genuinely moved)
Your kids are right. You're the real one. I'm just wearing it for two hours.

CUT TO:

EXT. EL CAPITAN THEATRE - RED CARPET - CONTINUOUS

SUPER: 6:18 P.M. PDT

A car door opens. AMOND BAKER (32) gets out first and hurries around the car like a man defusing a bomb. He opens the passenger door and offers both hands.

HARMONY DIVINE (31) steps out in a flowing black gown that does nothing to hide her belly. Thirty-four weeks pregnant. The photographers lose their minds. She rests a hand on the bump and waves.

HARMONY
(to Amond, under her breath)
You can let go now. I'm standing.

AMOND
I'm not letting go until April twenty-first. That's the due date. That's the plan.

HARMONY
It's a carpet, not a cliff.

An E! NEWS REPORTER leans over the barricade.

E! REPORTER
Harmony! Black Widow is in some of the biggest action scenes in the movie. You shot them pregnant?

HARMONY
Every fight in this movie was finished by the end of June. I found out in August. She's been to Cleveland, Washington and an elevator fight, and she wasn't even there yet.

(beat)
I'm going to tell her she was in a Captain America movie before she was born.

E! REPORTER
And Amond, you're not in this one. What are you doing here?

AMOND
Carrying the purse. Holding the elbow. Asking for the ottoman. I'm support staff tonight. I don't even know what happens in this movie.

(to camera, seriously)
Nobody tells me anything. Nobody has ever told me anything.

CUT TO:

EXT. EL CAPITAN THEATRE - RED CARPET - LATER

SUPER: 6:30 P.M. PDT

MARC-ANTHONY BULLOCK (32) arrives with ESTHER SMILLEY (31), both wearing new gold wedding bands that every camera on the carpet zooms in on. It's their first red carpet as a married couple since December. The crowd chants "TONY! THOR! TONY! THOR!"

MTV NEWS REPORTER
Marc-Anthony! You were in Thor's mid-credits scene. Are you in this one too? The internet thinks you're in every Marvel post-credits scene now.

MARC-ANTHONY
(very seriously)
I have a clause in my contract. It's called the Cameo Clause. Every Marvel movie has to have me in the credits, or a shot of my car, or my hand holding a cheeseburger. In ANT-MAN 2 I'm an ant. In GUARDIANS OF THE GALAXY I'm the raccoon's stunt double.

ESTHER
(deadpan)
He's not the raccoon's stunt double. He auditioned. They went another way.

MARC-ANTHONY
They said I was "too tall for a raccoon." Hollywood is cruel.

Esther pulls him away, laughing. Behind them, a quiet arrival. GRACE BULLOCK (19), Marc-Anthony's little sister, in a crimson dress, holding hands with nobody, and ELIJAH BLACKMAN (19), lanky, in a silver-gray suit. They walk the carpet side by side and keep looking at each other, nervous.

ACCESS HOLLYWOOD REPORTER
Grace! Elijah! Marvel announced in December that you're playing Wanda and Pietro Maximoff in AGE OF ULTRON. Why are you at a Captain America premiere?

GRACE
(a beat too fast)
Support! For Tyrese! He's been like a big brother to me since I was fourteen.

ELIJAH
(also too fast)
Support! Big support. I love Captain America. I love... the shield.

The reporter narrows her eyes. Grace grabs Elijah's arm and drags him down the carpet.

GRACE
(whispering)
"I love the shield"?!

ELIJAH
(whispering)
I panicked! I've never kept a secret this big! I'm nineteen!

GRACE
I'm nineteen too!

ELIJAH
You're a Bullock. You were born keeping secrets.

CUT TO:

EXT. EL CAPITAN THEATRE - RED CARPET - CONTINUOUS

SUPER: 6:44 P.M. PDT

A rush of the cast: SAMUEL L. JACKSON (65), Nick Fury, eyepatch-free and grinning. ROBERT REDFORD (77), Alexander Pierce, in a classic gray suit, the most composed man on Hollywood Boulevard. ANTHONY MACKIE (35), Sam Wilson, the Falcon, doing a little dance for the fans. COBIE SMULDERS (31), Maria Hill. EMILY VANCAMP (27), Sharon Carter. FRANK GRILLO (48), Brock Rumlow. GEORGES ST-PIERRE (32), Batroc. HAYLEY ATWELL (31), Peggy Carter. TOBY JONES (47), Arnim Zola, quietly signing autographs at the very end of the barricade, a man with the biggest secret in the building and a face nobody recognizes.

And MADS MIKKELSEN (48), cast as Aleksander Lukin, the Russian general turned oligarch from Ed Brubaker's comics, in a sleek black suit. He gives a reporter one line, and the line ends up in a hundred articles.

MADS MIKKELSEN
Lukin has a passenger in his head. That's all I'm allowed to tell you. A passenger.

CUT TO:

INT. EL CAPITAN THEATRE - AUDITORIUM - NIGHT

SUPER: 7:35 P.M. PDT

The film plays. A montage, intercut with the audience.

ON SCREEN: A ship hijacked in the Indian Ocean. Steve Rogers drops out of a quinjet without a parachute. He works his way through the ship in one unbroken take with the STRIKE team, ending in a brutal fight with Batroc. Every punch real, both men's own stunts.

ON SCREEN: Steve in the Smithsonian, standing before his own memorial exhibit, watching footage of Bucky Barnes laughing in 1943.

ON SCREEN: Fury's SUV attacked in the streets of Washington. A real armored SUV, real D.C. streets closed for four nights. A figure in black walks down

the middle of the road and tears the car door off with a silver metal arm.

IN THE AUDIENCE: a ripple of horror and delight. Tyler, in the center section, sinks down in his seat. The veterans, in their reserved row, lean forward together.

ON SCREEN: The elevator. Steve alone, then ten STRIKE agents in a glass elevator in a real Washington office tower. Rumlow, behind him, says quietly, "It's nothing personal, Cap." The fight that follows is brutal.

IN THE AUDIENCE: Cheers, gasps and groans at every hit.

CUT TO:

INT. EL CAPITAN THEATRE - AUDITORIUM - THE VAULT - CONTINUOUS

SUPER: 8:41 P.M. PDT

ON SCREEN: Camp Lehigh, New Jersey. The old Army base where Steve trained in 1943, real, and abandoned. Under the barracks, Steve and Natasha find a hidden vault. A wall of 1970s computer banks hums to life.

On a monitor, a face made of green light. Then something worse: a figure rises from a maintenance cradle in the shadows. A robotic body, seven feet tall, with no head at all. In the middle of the chest, a television screen shows Arnim Zola's face. It's straight out of Jack Kirby's 1977 comics, built practically from steel, fiberglass and a real flat-screen.

IN THE AUDIENCE: A gasp. Then a few comic fans start whooping. "THAT'S ZOLA! THAT'S THE REAL ZOLA!"

TOBY JONES (ON SCREEN, AS ZOLA)
(his face on the chest screen, mild, amused)
Captain Rogers. I died in 1972. My mind, however, has been working for S.H.I.E.L.D. ever since. Or should I say... for us.

TYRESE (ON SCREEN, AS STEVE)
HYDRA died with the Skull.

TOBY JONES (ON SCREEN, AS ZOLA)
Cut off one head, Captain. You know the rest.

(beat)
You believe HYDRA crept into S.H.I.E.L.D. like a worm into an apple. No. We planted the tree. In 1946, when your friends built S.H.I.E.L.D., they built it with our hands. Every agent you trusted. Every order you obeyed. S.H.I.E.L.D. was never infiltrated, Captain.

(he smiles)
S.H.I.E.L.D. was born HYDRA.

IN THE AUDIENCE: Silence. A total, stunned silence. Then a sound spreads through the El Capitan, a sound the Russos will later describe as "a thousand people saying 'oh no' at the same time."

In the fifth row, Amond Baker grabs Harmony's arm.

AMOND
(whispering, horrified)
Coulson. Coulson works for HYDRA?! Does Coulson know?!

HARMONY
(whispering, wincing)
Coulson doesn't know. Coulson's going to find out on a Tuesday.

AMOND
YOU KNEW?!

HARMONY
I was IN the scene, baby.

Harmony suddenly gasps and grips her belly.

AMOND
(panicking instantly)
What? WHAT? Is it...? Do we go? Should we...?

HARMONY
(laughing, breathless)
She kicked. She kicked when Zola said "HYDRA." She's a critic.

CUT TO:

INT. EL CAPITAN THEATRE - AUDITORIUM - THE FALL - LATER

SUPER: 9:05 P.M. PDT

ON SCREEN: The Triskelion on the Potomac. Alexander Pierce in his office overlooking the river. Steve Rogers, a hunted man, is in the room with him. Pierce opens his desk drawer. The audience tenses; everybody saw the trailers. Everybody expects Redford to be the villain.

Pierce takes out a S.H.I.E.L.D. badge, his own, and slides it across the desk.

ROBERT REDFORD (ON SCREEN, AS PIERCE)
I've worn that for thirty-one years. I just found out what it means.

(he stands)
Lukin owns the Council. Rumlow owns STRIKE. And I own exactly one thing left in this building, Captain: the master override for the broadcast system. You'll want it.

IN THE AUDIENCE: a gasp of surprise. A murmur: "He's GOOD?"

ON SCREEN: Pierce walks out ahead of Steve, into a corridor full of HYDRA agents, and buys him forty seconds with his life. The legendary Redford, shot through the heart, sitting down slowly against a wall, still holding the override key for Steve to take.

ROBERT REDFORD (ON SCREEN, AS PIERCE)
(dying, calm)
Tell Nick... he was right about me. Tell him I was proud of it.

ON SCREEN: The Triskelion broadcast room. Steve at the microphone. Every S.H.I.E.L.D. agent in the building hears him: the honest ones and the HYDRA ones, side by side at their desks.

TYRESE (ON SCREEN, AS STEVE)
This is Steve Rogers. You've all heard a lot about me. I'd like to tell you something about yourselves.

(beat)
Some of you are HYDRA. You've been HYDRA since before you were born. And some of you are the bravest people I've ever met, who've been serving them without knowing it. I don't know which one of you is which. Neither do you.

(beat)
So here's what I'm going to do. I'm going to give the world every secret this building ever kept, all of them, theirs and ours, and let the world decide. And then this place is going to fall. S.H.I.E.L.D. ends today. If you're with me, stand up.

ON SCREEN: In the control room, one young technician stands. Then another. Then dozens. And in the middle of the floor, a man in a suit draws a gun on the first technician, and the agent beside him tackles him to the ground.

IN THE AUDIENCE: The veterans' row is on its feet. Then the whole theater.

ON SCREEN: Natasha Romanoff at a terminal, uploading. Every S.H.I.E.L.D. file since 1946, broadcast to every news network on earth. Including her own.

HARMONY (ON SCREEN, AS NATASHA)
They're going to see everything I've ever done.

TYRESE (ON SCREEN, AS STEVE)
So will I. Push the button, Natasha.

She pushes it.

CUT TO:

INT. EL CAPITAN THEATRE - AUDITORIUM - THE PASSENGER - CONTINUOUS

SUPER: 9:18 P.M. PDT

ON SCREEN: The helicarrier deck over the Potomac, falling apart. Aleksander Lukin, cornered, a glowing blue shard of crystal in his fist: a fragment of the Cosmic Cube, recovered from the Battle of New York and stolen out of a S.H.I.E.L.D. vault. Steve, battered, holds the shield. Behind Lukin's eyes, something moves.

MADS MIKKELSEN (ON SCREEN, AS LUKIN)
You keep looking at me as if I were the man in charge.

Lukin's reflection in a shattered window is not Lukin. It is a red face, a skull, grinning.

VOICE OF THE RED SKULL (ON SCREEN)
(from Lukin's mouth, a different voice entirely)
Hello, Captain. Did you miss me?

IN THE AUDIENCE: A scream. A real one, from the radio-contest section. "THE SKULL'S IN HIS HEAD! THAT'S BRUBAKER! THAT'S BRUBAKER!" A grown man, standing on his chair.

ON SCREEN: The helicarrier blows apart. Lukin, the Skull in his head and the shard in his hand, falls into the smoke and the Potomac and is gone. No body.

CUT TO:

INT. EL CAPITAN THEATRE - AUDITORIUM - THE RIVERBANK - LATER

SUPER: 9:24 P.M. PDT

ON SCREEN: The bank of the Potomac. Steve drags the Winter Soldier out of the water. Both of them are broken, gasping, half drowned. On the mud between them, a small blue shard, glowing. The piece of the Cube that broke off Lukin's fragment in the explosion.

Steve picks it up. It hums in his hand. He knows exactly what it can do. He kneels beside his best friend.

TYRESE (ON SCREEN, AS STEVE)
(barely a whisper)
I don't know if this works. I don't know if it's right. But you're my friend.

(he presses the shard into the Winter Soldier's metal hand)
Remember.

A blinding blue light. The Winter Soldier's eyes go wide. Then a flood of faces: Brooklyn in 1936. Steve, skinny, punching above his weight in an alley. The war. The train. The fall. And then decades of murders in the dark, every single one, at once.

He screams. It's a sound of pure, unbearable grief. He scrambles back away from Steve through the mud, shaking.

TYLER (ON SCREEN, AS BUCKY)
(choking)
Steve. Steve. What did I do? WHAT DID I DO?

TYRESE (ON SCREEN, AS STEVE)
Buck...

Bucky runs. Into the trees. Gone. Steve, on his knees in the mud, alone, the shard burned out and gray in his hand.

IN THE AUDIENCE: Tyler Chapman has his face in his hands. Tyrese reaches over two seats and grips his shoulder. Down the row, Sergeant Okafor is wiping her eyes with her prosthetic hand.

ON SCREEN: A Senate hearing room. A news chyron: "S.H.I.E.L.D. DISSOLVED BY ACT OF CONGRESS - 'THE AVENGERS ARE NOW ACCOUNTABLE TO NO ONE,' SAYS SENATOR." Steve at the witness table in his old Army dress uniform.

SENATOR (ON SCREEN)
Captain, you destroyed the most important intelligence agency in the free world. Who's going to protect this country now?

TYRESE (ON SCREEN, AS STEVE)
The people in it, Senator. Same as always. I'm not here to answer for S.H.I.E.L.D. I'm here to bury it.

ON SCREEN: A graveyard. A headstone: "NICHOLAS J. FURY." Steve and Sam at the grave. A figure in a hoodie, in the trees: Fury himself, alive, his eyepatch on, alone. He nods to Steve. Then he walks away toward a black car with a small group of very young, very serious people waiting inside. On the car door, a symbol nobody in the theater has seen before.

IN THE AUDIENCE: the comic fans gasp again. "SECRET WARRIORS! THAT'S QUAKE IN THE CAR!"

The film ends. The audience applauds for two minutes straight. Then sits back down. Everybody knows.

CUT TO:

INT. EL CAPITAN THEATRE - AUDITORIUM - THE MID-CREDITS SCENE - NIGHT

SUPER: 9:33 P.M. PDT

ON SCREEN: A snowbound mountain under a full moon. A title in white type: "WUNDAGORE MOUNTAIN, TRANSIA."

A HYDRA fortress built into the rock. Inside, a corridor of thick glass cells. BARON WOLFGANG VON STRUCKER (THOMAS KRETSCHMANN), monocle in his eye, a dueling scar on his cheek, walks the corridor with a frightened HYDRA SCIENTIST.

HYDRA SCIENTIST (ON SCREEN)
Baron. With S.H.I.E.L.D. gone, the Americans will come looking for every HYDRA facility on the planet. We should move them.

KRETSCHMANN (ON SCREEN, AS STRUCKER)
Let them come. I want them to see.

He stops at the last two cells.

In the first: a young man, white-haired, pacing. Every so often he simply stops being in one place and is in another, a blur, a crack in the air, back at the wall before the eye can follow. PIETRO MAXIMOFF (ELIJAH BLACKMAN).

In the second: a young woman, dark-haired, sitting perfectly still on her bunk, hands in her lap. WANDA MAXIMOFF (GRACE BULLOCK). Her eyes follow the

Baron.

KRETSCHMANN (ON SCREEN, AS STRUCKER)
Our scientists spent seventy years trying to build a super soldier. Erskine's serum. Zola's machines. All of it.

(he looks at the twins)
We found these two in a village at the foot of this mountain. We did nothing to them. Nothing at all. They were simply... born.

HYDRA SCIENTIST (ON SCREEN)
Born like that? How?

KRETSCHMANN (ON SCREEN, AS STRUCKER)
That is the question that will define the next century.

Wanda raises one hand, slowly, and spreads her fingers. A shimmer of scarlet light. In the corridor, the scientist's clipboard slips out of his hand. His pen rolls under the door of a supply closet. A ceiling light flickers out. A fire sprinkler bursts over his head. Every small unlucky thing that could happen to a man happens all at once.

The scientist stumbles back, soaked, terrified.

GRACE (ON SCREEN, AS WANDA)
(softly, in a Transian accent)
You should keep your distance, Baron. Bad luck is catching.

A rush of wind. Pietro is suddenly pressed right up against the glass of his cell, inches from Strucker's face, grinning.

ELIJAH (ON SCREEN, AS PIETRO)
Funny thing about glass, Baron. Hit it fast enough, enough times...

A fine crack appears in the glass under his palm. Then another. Then a hundred, a spiderweb spreading in the time it takes to blink.

ELIJAH (ON SCREEN, AS PIETRO) (CONT'D)
...and it remembers.

SMASH TO BLACK.

Title card: "AVENGERS: AGE OF ULTRON - MAY 1, 2015."

IN THE AUDIENCE: Pandemonium. The loudest noise of the night.

In the third row, the Bullock family. Victor Donohue (77) is on his feet, applauding with his cane under his arm. Joan (75) has both hands pressed to her heart. Robert Bullock (55), the director, is studying the shot composition, crying anyway. Natasha (52) is staring at her youngest child's face on the screen like she's never seen it before.

NATASHA
(to herself)
She was fourteen when I canceled her show.

She doesn't say anything else. She doesn't have to. Robert squeezes her hand.

Two seats away, Grace has disappeared entirely behind her program. Elijah is grinning like a lunatic.

ELIJAH
(leaning over to her)
Grace. GRACE. They screamed. For US.

GRACE
(from behind the program)
I can't look. Is my mother crying? Tell me if my mother is crying.

ELIJAH
(looking down the row)
...Your mother is crying.

Grace lowers the program. Natasha is looking right at her, tears on her face. She doesn't say a word. She just nods at her daughter, once. Grace has to cover her mouth.

Marc-Anthony leans across Esther and grabs his little sister's hand.

MARC-ANTHONY
(fierce, proud)
Bad luck is catching. You came up with that line, didn't you.

GRACE
(laughing through tears)
In the makeup trailer. Joe Russo let me keep it.

MARC-ANTHONY
That's a Bullock line. That's a family line.

CUT TO:

INT. EL CAPITAN THEATRE - AUDITORIUM - THE END-CREDITS SCENE - LATER

SUPER: 9:43 P.M. PDT

The last credit rolls. And then:

ON SCREEN: New York City. Fifth Avenue at 70th Street, across from Central Park. A gray, rainy morning. A grand old mansion, eight bedrooms, carved stone, with a wrought-iron gate. Steve Rogers stands on the sidewalk with a duffel bag, the shield on his back under a canvas cover.

A sleek Audi pulls up. Tony Stark gets out with an umbrella and a ring of old brass keys.

IN THE AUDIENCE: A roar of laughter and cheers. "MARC-ANTHONY! HE'S IN THIS ONE TOO!"

In his seat, Marc-Anthony turns around, takes a slow bow to the row behind him, and sits back down.

MARC-ANTHONY (ON SCREEN, AS TONY STARK)
Heard you got evicted.

TYRESE (ON SCREEN, AS STEVE)
I burned the landlord down.

MARC-ANTHONY (ON SCREEN, AS TONY STARK)
Same thing.

(he tosses Steve the ring of keys)
Eight ninety Fifth Avenue. My father's place. My mother hated it. I never lived in it. It has a gym, a library, a sub-basement that I don't legally have to tell anyone about, and the best view of the park in Manhattan.

TYRESE (ON SCREEN, AS STEVE)
Tony. I can't take your father's house.

MARC-ANTHONY (ON SCREEN, AS TONY STARK)
You're not taking it. The Avengers are.

(he points up at the gate)
No S.H.I.E.L.D. No helicarrier. No Fury on speed dial. If we're going to be accountable to the people, the people need to know where we live.

A worker on a ladder unveils a brass plaque on the gate. Five words, engraved: "THE AVENGERS - EST. 2012 - NEW YORK."

IN THE AUDIENCE: A gasp of recognition, and then cheers. "AVENGERS MANSION! IT'S AVENGERS MANSION!"

ON SCREEN: Steve stares at it. Then he holds out his hand. Tony shakes it.

Then the camera drifts away, across Fifth Avenue, across the wet street to the low wall of Central Park, where a figure in a dark hoodie and a baseball cap stands in the rain, one gloved left hand jammed in his pocket.

Bucky Barnes. Watching his best friend through the rain. He lifts his chin, about to cross the street...

Then he turns away and disappears into the park.

SMASH TO BLACK.

Title card: "CAPTAIN AMERICA WILL RETURN."

IN THE AUDIENCE: The second roar of the night.

AMOND
(on his feet, turning to Marc-Anthony, outraged)
YOU WERE IN IT AGAIN! YOU WERE IN IT AGAIN, AND YOU TOLD ME YOU WERE AT THE DENTIST!

MARC-ANTHONY
I was at the dentist. The dentist was on Fifth Avenue. In New York.

AMOND
(pointing at everyone in the row, one by one)
Did EVERYBODY know? Esther? Grace? Elijah? HARMONY?

HARMONY
(patting the empty seat beside her)
Sit down, baby. You'll scare the baby.

Amond sits down, defeated. Then he looks at Harmony's belly.

AMOND
(quietly, to the bump)
Don't you ever keep secrets from me. You hear me? You and me. We're going to be the only two people in this family who tell each other things.

Harmony laughs so hard she has to hold on to his arm.

CUT TO:

TWITTER.COM - PUBLIC TIMELINE - THURSDAY, MARCH 13, 2014

amondbaker: just found out at the world premiere along with 1,000 strangers that i've been personally lied to by: my best friend, my best friend's wife, my best friend's sister, the guy playing my best friend's sister's twin brother, and the mother of my child. #WinterSoldier 10:15 PM Mar 13th from Twitter for iPhone

harmonydivine: @amondbaker in my defense the mother of your child was legally bound by an NDA 10:19 PM Mar 13th from Twitter for iPhone

marcanthonyb: the dentist was very good 10:22 PM Mar 13th from Twitter for iPhone

tyreseavery: my grandfather would have been 89 this year. tonight i stood in front of a thousand people and tore down the house that was supposed to protect them. he would have understood why. #WinterSoldier 11:40 PM Mar 13th from Twitter for iPhone

PART TWO: THE WORLD FINDS OUT

THE GUARDIAN - THURSDAY, MARCH 27, 2014

'CAPTAIN AMERICA' FILM HAS A TWIST THAT SHOULD WORRY YOU, AND MARVEL KNOWS IT

"Without giving it away: the institution that has stood behind every Marvel film since 2008 turns out to be rotten all the way down, and Captain America's answer is not reform. It is disclosure. In the year of Edward Snowden, a $170 million studio picture argues that a free people are safer knowing the truth than being protected from it. It opened across Britain on Wednesday. Audiences at the Odeon Leicester Square stood up and applauded the upload scene."

REDDIT.COM - r/marvelstudios - "[INTERNATIONAL SPOILERS] THE WINTER SOLDIER - S.H.I.E.L.D. DISCUSSION" - 22,904 comments

u/ShieldOfVibranium (London, Mar 26, 11:02 PM GMT)
"S.H.I.E.L.D. was never infiltrated. S.H.I.E.L.D. was born HYDRA." I've been reading Marvel for 25 years and I KNEW Secret Warriors and it still knocked the wind out of me.

u/AussieAvenger (Sydney, Mar 27, 1:40 AM AEDT)
Rewatch the first Avengers knowing this. Every S.H.I.E.L.D. agent. Every order. Every time Fury got overruled by the Council. It was HYDRA the WHOLE TIME. Marvel just rewrote 8 movies retroactively.

u/BerlinBucky (Berlin, Mar 27, 2:15 AM CET)
Steve using the Cosmic Cube shard to give Bucky his memories back is from Captain America #14 (2006). It's the most comic accurate thing I've ever seen and the scream when he remembers is going to haunt me.

u/RedSkullIsInLukin (Toronto, Mar 27, 9:30 AM EDT)
THE SKULL IS INSIDE LUKIN. THE BRUBAKER TWIST. AND THEY DIDN'T KILL HIM. "No body." The Red Skull is ALIVE in the MCU and he's got a piece of the Cosmic Cube.

u/AgentsFan2013 (Seoul, Mar 27, 3:00 PM KST)
Uh. Guys. What happens to AGENTS OF S.H.I.E.L.D. now? The show is called AGENTS OF S.H.I.E.L.D. There IS no S.H.I.E.L.D. Is the show canceled? Is Coulson HYDRA?? I need to know before the U.S. episode on April 8.

YOUTUBE.COM - "WINTER SOLDIER MID-CREDITS SCENE AUDIENCE REACTION - SEOUL (SCARLET WITCH & QUICKSILVER!!)" - uploaded by kpop_and_marvel - 7,881,442 views in 8 days

Description: 0:14 the whole theater screams at the white hair. 0:47 "bad luck is catching" - listen to the girl next to me. 1:10 "AGE OF ULTRON" card. marvel twins confirmed. they were BORN that way. the baron said it. nobody experimented on them. nobody MADE them.

TUMBLR - REBLOGGED 288,104 TIMES

Picture: a screenshot of Strucker in the cell corridor, with his line in white subtitles: "We did nothing to them. Nothing at all. They were simply... born."

Caption: *"Marvel isn't allowed to say the word 'mutant' because of the movie rights. So they said it without saying it. 'They were simply born.' 'That is the question that will define the next century.' THEY'RE MUTANTS AND MARVEL JUST TOLD US IN THE MOST BEAUTIFUL WAY POSSIBLE."*

PART THREE: OPENING NIGHT

EXT. AMC UNIVERSAL CITYWALK 19 WITH IMAX - THE LINE - NIGHT

SUPER: THURSDAY, APRIL 3, 2014 - 7:20 P.M. PDT - FIRST NORTH AMERICAN SHOWS

The same four friends, the same spot on the line. GARY MORRIS (48), in a Captain America T-shirt from 1990 so faded the star is gray. DR. PRIYA SHAH (29), now a postdoctoral fellow at UCLA, in a S.H.I.E.L.D. agent jacket she bought in 2012. DARNELL JOHNSON (36). TOMMY RUIZ (26), on spoiler blackout again: noise-canceling headphones, sleep mask, a sign around his neck: "I DON'T KNOW ANYTHING AND I'M HAPPY."

PRIYA
(looking at her S.H.I.E.L.D. jacket, troubled)
I've read three spoiler-free reviews. Every one of them says there's a twist about S.H.I.E.L.D. I'm suddenly very worried about my jacket.

DARNELL
It's a costume, Priya. It's not a membership.

PRIYA
What if it's a membership in something bad?

GARY
Then you'll be the only postdoc at UCLA in a HYDRA jacket. That's still pretty cool.

TOMMY
(loudly, through the headphones)
I CAN'T HEAR YOU, BUT I KNOW YOU'RE SAYING SOMETHING ABOUT S.H.I.E.L.D.

CUT TO:

INT. AMC UNIVERSAL CITYWALK - IMAX AUDITORIUM - LATER

SUPER: THURSDAY, APRIL 3, 2014 - 9:21 P.M. PDT

On the IMAX screen: Zola's face on the chest of the robot. "S.H.I.E.L.D. was born HYDRA."

In the front row, Priya slowly unzips her S.H.I.E.L.D. jacket, takes it off and lays it across her knees like a flag on a coffin.

PRIYA
(whispering)
Secret Warriors. They did Secret Warriors.

GARY
(whispering, stunned)
Every S.H.I.E.L.D. scene since 2008. Coulson. Hill. The Council. All of it.

Tommy, without his headphones now, is gripping his armrests.

TOMMY
(whispering)
Is Coulson HYDRA? Is Coulson HYDRA?! Somebody tell me COULSON ISN'T HYDRA!

DARNELL
Nobody knows, Tommy. Not yet. Tuesday.

CUT TO:

INT. AMC UNIVERSAL CITYWALK - IMAX AUDITORIUM - THE CREDITS - LATER

SUPER: 10:21 P.M. PDT

The mid-credits scene. The cell. "They were simply... born." The scarlet light. The cracking glass. The title card.

Darnell is out of his seat.

DARNELL
WUNDAGORE MOUNTAIN! THAT'S WHERE THEY WERE BORN IN THE COMICS! THE HIGH EVOLUTIONARY'S MOUNTAIN!

PRIYA
"They were simply born." THEY'RE MUTANTS. THEY SAID IT WITHOUT SAYING IT.

GARY
(sitting very still)
Kooky Quartet. AVENGERS #16. Cap, Hawkeye, Quicksilver, Scarlet Witch. Age of Ultron ends with the Kooky Quartet. I'm calling it right now, and if I'm wrong I'll owe myself an apology.

The end-credits scene. Tony tosses the keys. The brass plaque. The figure in the rain.

The theater roars. Tommy is standing on his seat.

TOMMY
AVENGERS MANSION! EIGHT NINETY FIFTH AVENUE! THE AVENGERS HAVE A HOUSE!

GARY
(quietly, as Bucky walks into the park)
Two hundred and nineteen. I said, in 2009, on page six of the Captain America casting thread, that Bucky should stay dead.

PRIYA
You did. I have screenshots.

GARY
Of course you do.

CUT TO:

TWITTER.COM - TRENDING TOPICS (WORLDWIDE) - FRIDAY, APRIL 4, 2014

#WinterSoldier - #HailHydra - Born HYDRA - Avengers Mansion - Scarlet Witch - Quicksilver - Is Coulson HYDRA - Bad Luck Is Catching - Red Skull

TWITTER.COM - PUBLIC TIMELINE

gracebullock: my first time on screen in a marvel movie and it was in a cell. my mom cried. my brother cried. elijah cried. i'm fine. i'm totally fine. (i'm not fine) #ScarletWitch 12:30 AM Apr 4th from Twitter for iPhone

elijahblackman: i made one crack in some glass and the internet broke. this is the best day of my life. #Quicksilver 12:41 AM Apr 4th from Twitter for iPhone

tylerchapman: to every veteran who came to see us and told me what the arm means to them: thank you. i'll carry it more carefully now. #WinterSoldier 1:10 AM Apr 4th from Twitter for iPhone

esthersmilley: my husband has now snuck into the credits of two marvel movies in a row that aren't his. he says it's a contract clause. it is not a contract clause. he just asks nicely 9:00 AM Apr 4th from Twitter for iPhone

priya_shah_phd: i bought a S.H.I.E.L.D. jacket in 2012. i'm now reconsidering a lot of my life choices. #HailHydra 9:30 AM Apr 4th from Twitter for iPhone

SUPERHEROHYPE.COM - THREAD: "WINTER SOLDIER - WHAT DOES THE END OF S.H.I.E.L.D. MEAN?" (Page 1 of 1,213)

ShellHead1963 (Apr 4, 2:12 AM)
Let's think about this logically. No S.H.I.E.L.D. means no government oversight of the Avengers. They have a house on Fifth Avenue. They're "accountable to the people." What happens when the people want them accountable to the government? That's the Superhuman Registration Act. That's CIVIL WAR.

priya_shah_phd (Apr 4, 2:30 AM)
Gary's right. And listen to the Senator: "The Avengers are now accountable to no one." That line is a SEED. Somebody in Washington is going to want a leash.

Gamma_Gamma_Hey (Apr 4, 2:44 AM)
And Fury went underground with what looked like Daisy Johnson in the car. SECRET WARRIORS. The show is going to be about the agents who are left, picking up the pieces with no agency behind them.

DarnellDoesComics (Apr 4, 3:15 AM)
The Red Skull is alive inside Lukin with a piece of the Cube. Bucky's got his memories and he's running. Wanda and Pietro are BORN with powers. Ultron is saying "Father." Thanos is shopping for gems. Phase Two is building a bomb and we're all sitting on it.

TommyTwoGuns (Apr 4, 3:40 AM)
I'm still standing on my chair, emotionally

PART FOUR: THE GRAVE

INT. DONOHUE ENTERTAINMENT - EXECUTIVE TOWER - NATASHA'S OFFICE - BURBANK - MORNING

SUPER: SUNDAY, APRIL 6, 2014 - 8:30 A.M. PDT

Natasha (52) at her desk on a Sunday. Feige (40) on the speakerphone. In the corner, on the couch, Grace (19) with a mug of tea, still in her pajama pants. She came to the office with her mother this morning, for the first time in her life.

FEIGE (V.O.)
Friday: thirty-eight point two, including ten point six from Thursday night. Saturday: thirty-five point nine. Sunday estimated at twenty-nine point six. One hundred and three point seven million dollars.

NATASHA
Compared to?

FEIGE (V.O.)
It's the biggest April opening in history. Beats FAST FIVE by seventeen million. It's nearly sixty percent bigger than THE FIRST AVENGER's opening. Worldwide total, three hundred and three point eight million dollars.

NATASHA
And the exit polls.

FEIGE (V.O.)
An A from CinemaScore. And Natasha... the most-cited scene in the exit polls, above the elevator fight, above the Zola reveal, is the mid-credits scene. Wanda and Pietro.

Natasha turns slowly to look at her daughter on the couch. Grace has frozen with the mug halfway to her mouth.

NATASHA
Thank you, Kevin. I'll call you back.

She hangs up. The office is quiet. Natasha takes her glasses off, folds them, and sets them on the desk.

NATASHA (CONT'D)
In 2005 I canceled your show.

GRACE
(quietly)
I know, Mom.

NATASHA
I told the board it was a policy. No family members on the Donohue Channel. Nepotism. Optics.

(beat)
That was true. It was also true that I didn't want to watch you get hurt the way your brother got hurt when he was a kid. Every review. Every tabloid. Every grown man with an opinion about a child.

GRACE
You never told me that.

NATASHA
I'm telling you now. I was wrong to make the choice for you. You were fourteen and you were good. You were very good.

(she looks at the exit poll on her desk)
You still are. "Bad luck is catching." Your brother told me you wrote it.

Grace puts the mug down. She crosses the office and puts her arms around her mother, who is sitting in a CEO's chair at a desk on the top floor of a billion-dollar tower. Natasha holds her daughter for a long time.

NATASHA (CONT'D)
(into Grace's hair, softly)
Don't tell your brother I said any of this. He'll put it in a toast.

GRACE
(laughing, crying)
He's going to put it in a toast anyway.

CUT TO:

EXT. MOUNT ZION CEMETERY - OUTSIDE ALBANY, GEORGIA - DAY

SUPER: MONDAY, APRIL 7, 2014 - 4:15 P.M. EDT

A small, quiet church cemetery under tall Georgia pines. Red clay, wildflowers and old headstones. Tyrese Avery (32), alone, in jeans and a plain black T-shirt, stands in front of a gray granite stone.

"PVT. WALTER LEE AVERY - 1925-2009 - 333RD FIELD ARTILLERY BATTALION - HE REMEMBERED WHAT IT WAS SUPPOSED TO BE."

Tyrese sets down a small object at the base of the headstone: a 1964 comic book in a plastic sleeve. CAPTAIN AMERICA, in TALES OF SUSPENSE. Then he sits down cross-legged in the grass, the way he used to sit on the floor beside his grandfather's chair.

TYRESE
Hey, Granddaddy.

(beat)
Biggest April opening ever. Hundred and three million. People clapped for Cap in Georgia this weekend, Granddaddy. In this county. I checked.

The wind moves through the pines.

TYRESE (CONT'D)
In the movie, Steve finds out the thing he's been working for is rotten. All the way down. From the first day. And all the good people inside it were working for something evil without knowing it.

(he picks at the grass)
Everybody keeps asking me how Cap could tear it all down. They say: weren't there good people in S.H.I.E.L.D.? Wasn't there some good in it?

(beat)
I tell them what you told me. You can love something and still refuse to lie about what it is. That's what loving it means.

He's quiet for a long time.

TYRESE (CONT'D)
You came home in uniform and they wouldn't serve you at the counter. And you still said Cap was what we're supposed to be.

(his voice breaks)
I think I finally understand what you meant. "Supposed to be" isn't a place we already got to. It's a direction. You keep walking.

He wipes his eyes, stands, and brushes the clay off his jeans. He touches the top of the headstone with two fingers.

TYRESE (CONT'D)
I'll keep walking.

He walks back to the rental car parked on the dirt road. On the passenger seat, his phone lights up with a text from Tyler: "you okay? you disappeared." He types back: "visiting family. back tomorrow. we did good, buck."

FADE OUT.

PART FIVE: THE TUESDAY

INT. ABC STUDIOS - "AGENTS OF S.H.I.E.L.D." STAGE 5 - CULVER CITY - NIGHT

SUPER: TUESDAY, APRIL 8, 2014 - 6:00 P.M. PDT - 9:00 P.M. ON THE EAST COAST

A soundstage dressed as the interior of a S.H.I.E.L.D. plane, the cockpit and lounge built at full scale. Tonight, the cast and crew of AGENTS OF S.H.I.E.L.D. are watching the East Coast feed on a projector screen set up in the plane's lounge: Episode 17, "Turn, Turn, Turn."

CLARK GREGG (52), Agent Coulson, sits on the stairs of the plane set with a bowl of popcorn. JEPH LOEB (56) stands at the back, arms crossed, watching the cast instead of the screen.

ON THE PROJECTOR: Coulson's team, aboard their plane, learning that S.H.I.E.L.D. has fallen. One of their own, a trusted agent, turns out to be HYDRA. The episode ends with Coulson standing in the wreckage of everything he believed, holding his badge.

As the credits roll, the cast applauds. Gregg turns to Loeb.

CLARK GREGG
A year ago you told me the movie was going to burn my house down.

JEPH LOEB
I did.

CLARK GREGG
I didn't think you meant it would be the best thing that ever happened to the house.

Loeb hands him a phone. On it, the overnight ratings from New York, already circulating among network executives.

JEPH LOEB
Biggest audience since the pilot. Twitter's going crazy. They're saying the show "finally found its purpose."

CLARK GREGG
(looking at the screen, quietly)
Coulson's purpose. Building something true out of the ashes of something rotten.

(beat)
That's a Fury line, isn't it.

JEPH LOEB
It's a Hickman line. And now it's yours.

CUT TO:

DEADLINE.COM - WEDNESDAY, APRIL 9, 2014, 8:05 AM PT

RATINGS: 'AGENTS OF S.H.I.E.L.D.' SURGES AFTER 'WINTER SOLDIER' TIE-IN; ABC'S MOVIE-TV CROSSOVER GAMBLE PAYS OFF

The episode, which picked up directly from the events of Marvel's #1 film, delivered the series' biggest audience since September. "No network show has ever had a $170 million feature blow up its premise mid-season," says one rival executive. "It's either the dumbest idea in the history of television or the smartest. Last night, it looked like the smartest."

HEADLINES

SUPER: MONDAY, APRIL 14, 2014

BOX OFFICE MOJO - WEEKEND OF APRIL 11-13, 2014

1. CAPTAIN AMERICA: THE WINTER SOLDIER (Donohue) - $43.1M - Domestic: $172.4M - Worldwide: $476.9M

Second weekend drop of just 58%. The film is on pace to become the highest-grossing CAPTAIN AMERICA film by a wide margin.

THE NEW YORK TIMES - ARTS - SUNDAY, APRIL 13, 2014

CAPTAIN AMERICA, WHISTLE-BLOWER

"The most successful April release in Hollywood history ends with its hero refusing to save a government agency, and audiences cheering him for it. Ten months after the Snowden disclosures, the political right and left have both claimed the film as their own. The actor who plays Captain America, Tyrese Avery, says it belongs to neither. 'It belongs to my grandfather,' he told The Times."

VARIETY - MONDAY, APRIL 14, 2014

WHAT 'WINTER SOLDIER' MEANS FOR MARVEL: NO S.H.I.E.L.D., A MANSION ON FIFTH AVENUE, AND A COLLISION COURSE WITH 'CIVIL WAR'

Analysts say the decision to dissolve S.H.I.E.L.D., the connective tissue of 9 films and an ABC series, is the boldest structural gamble in franchise history. "Marvel just removed the parent from the room," one rival studio executive says. "Now the kids have a house. You can feel a custody fight coming."

ENTERTAINMENT WEEKLY - COVER (Issue of April 18, 2014)

THE TWINS

Grace Bullock and Elijah Blackman on their first scene as the Scarlet Witch and Quicksilver, the Transian village they were "born" in, and the mountain that comic fans already know by name: Wundagore. Plus: why Marvel says the twins "were never made."

JET MAGAZINE - (Issue of April 21, 2014)

THE GRANDSON OF A SOLDIER

Tyrese Avery visited his grandfather's grave in Georgia the morning after the biggest April opening in history. "He came home from the Bulge and couldn't sit at the lunch counter," Avery says. "Now his grandson is Captain America. Write that down. Write that his name was Walter."

PEOPLE.COM - MONDAY, APRIL 14, 2014

HARMONY DIVINE AND AMOND BAKER: BABY GIRL "ANY DAY NOW"

The Black Widow star, 31, is 39 weeks pregnant. Her partner, the Hulk star, 32, has been spotted buying baby car seats at a Target in Burbank. "He's bought three," says a source. "The baby is one baby. He has a lot of feelings."

FADE OUT.

END OF CHAPTER NINETEEN